

Rook pawns have edge exceptions

Endgame Technique

THE IDEA

A rook pawn offers fewer routes for the attacking king because one side of the pawn is off the board. A defending king that reaches the promotion corner can often draw a bare king-and-rook-pawn ending. Exact king placement still matters.

WORKED EXAMPLE

A white a-pawn promotes on a8. If Black's king occupies that corner and cannot be forced away, advancing the pawn may produce stalemate rather than victory. White cannot use squares to the left of the a-file to outflank.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

Why are general central-pawn rules unreliable for rook pawns?

ANSWER AND REASONING

The board edge removes key approach squares and creates stalemate resources. Calculate the actual corner position instead of transferring a central-pawn rule unchanged.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Check rook-pawn exceptions before simplifying.